

DATABASE MANAGEMENT SYSTEMS --- SAMPLE SOLUTION

Paper Code: -35 | Total Marks: 70 | Time: 2½ Hours

[6262]

Q1) a) Functional Dependency and Armstrong's Axioms

[9]

Functional Dependency (FD) is a constraint that describes the relationship between attributes in a relation. It is denoted as $X \rightarrow Y$, where X and Y are sets of attributes. This means that if two tuples have the same value for X, they must have the same value for Y.

Armstrong's Axioms are sound and complete inference rules used to derive all functional dependencies from a given set:

1. **Reflexivity:** If $Y \subseteq X$, then $X \rightarrow Y$
 - Example: $\{A, B\} \rightarrow A$
2. **Augmentation:** If $X \rightarrow Y$, then $XZ \rightarrow YZ$ for any Z
 - Example: If $A \rightarrow B$, then $AC \rightarrow BC$
3. **Transitivity:** If $X \rightarrow Y$ and $Y \rightarrow Z$, then $X \rightarrow Z$
 - Example: If $A \rightarrow B$ and $B \rightarrow C$, then $A \rightarrow C$

Additional derived rules:

- **Union:** If $X \rightarrow Y$ and $X \rightarrow Z$, then $X \rightarrow YZ$
- **Decomposition:** If $X \rightarrow YZ$, then $X \rightarrow Y$ and $X \rightarrow Z$
- **Pseudo-transitivity:** If $X \rightarrow Y$ and $WY \rightarrow Z$, then $WX \rightarrow Z$

Q1) b) Normalization Problem

[9]

Given: R(A, B, C, D, E) with FDs: $A \rightarrow BC$, $CD \rightarrow E$, $B \rightarrow D$, $E \rightarrow A$

i) Finding Candidate Keys:

- **Closure of A:** $A^+ = A \rightarrow BC \rightarrow BCD$ (via $B \rightarrow D$) $\rightarrow BCDE$ (via $CD \rightarrow E$) $\rightarrow ABCDE$ ✓
- **Closure of E:** $E^+ = E \rightarrow A$ (via $E \rightarrow A$) $\rightarrow ABCDE$ ✓
- **Closure of CD:** $CD^+ = CD \rightarrow E \rightarrow A \rightarrow BC \rightarrow D \dots \rightarrow ABCDE$ ✓

Candidate Keys: A, E, CD

ii) Highest Normal Form:

Check for BCNF --- every FD's LHS must be a superkey:

- $A \rightarrow BC$: A is a candidate key ✓
- $CD \rightarrow E$: CD is a candidate key ✓
- $B \rightarrow D$: B is **not** a superkey ✗ $\rightarrow$ R is **not in BCNF**
- $E \rightarrow A$: E is a candidate key ✓

Check for 3NF --- for each $X \rightarrow Y$, either X is a superkey or Y is prime:

- $B \rightarrow D$: B is not a superkey but D is not prime ✗ $\rightarrow$ R is **not in 3NF**

Highest Normal Form: 2NF (no partial dependencies exist since no composite key)

iii) Decomposition into 3NF:

Step1 : Canonicalcover $F_c = A \rightarrow B, A \rightarrow C, CD \rightarrow E, B \rightarrow D, E \rightarrow A$ *Step2 : $R_1(A, B, C), R_2(C, D, E), R_3(B, D), R_4(E, A)$* *Step3 : $R_5(A, C)$ not needed as A already*

Final 3NF Decomposition: R1(A, B, C), R2(B, D), R3(C, D, E), R4(E, A)

[ANSWER BOX]
Final Decomposition: R1(A,B,C), R2(B,D), R3(C,D,E), R4(E,A)
All in 3NF, lossless and dependency-preserving

Q2) a) Normalization Forms

[8]

Normalization is the process of organizing data in a database to reduce redundancy and eliminate anomalies (insertion, update, deletion).

1. **1NF: Each cell contains a single atomic value; no repeating groups.**
 - *Bad:* Student(Id, Name, Subjects) --- Subjects = {DBMS, TOC}
 - *Good:* Student(Id, Name, Subject) --- one row per subject
2. **2NF: In 1NF + no partial dependency (non-key attr must depend on full primary key).**
 - *Bad:* Enrollment(StudentId, CourseId, StudentName, Grade) --- StudentName depends only on StudentId
 - *Decompose:* Student(StudentId, Name), Enrollment(StudentId, CourseId, Grade)
3. **3NF: In 2NF + no transitive dependency (non-key attr must not depend on another non-key attr).**
 - *Bad:* Employee(EmpId, DeptId, DeptLocation) --- DeptLocation depends on DeptId
 - *Decompose:* Employee(EmpId, DeptId), Department(DeptId, DeptLocation)
4. **BCNF: In 3NF + every determinant must be a candidate key.**
 - *Bad:* StudentCourse(StudentId, CourseId, ProfessorName) where ProfessorName $\rightarrow$ CourseId
 - *Decompose:* StudentCourse(StudentId, ProfessorName), CourseProfessor(ProfessorName, CourseId)

Q2) b) Lossless Decomposition Check

[9]

Given: R(A, B, C, D, E, F) with FDs: $A \rightarrow B$, $C \rightarrow D$, $D \rightarrow E$, $B \rightarrow F$

Decomposition: R1(A, B, F), R2(C, D, E), R3(A, C)

Chase Algorithm:

	A	B	C	D	E	F
R1	a	b	c1	d1	e1	f
R2	a2	b2	c	d	e	f2
R3	a	b3	c	d3	e3	f3

Apply $A \rightarrow B$: $R3(A=a) \rightarrow R3.B = R1.B = b$ Apply $B \rightarrow F$: $R1(B=b) \rightarrow R1.F = R3.F = f$ Apply $C \rightarrow D$: $R2(C=c) \rightarrow R2.D = R3.D = d$ Apply $D \rightarrow E$: $R2(D=d) \rightarrow R2.E = R3.E = e$

Row R3 now has: (a, b, c, d, e, f) --- all distinguished symbols

The decomposition is LOSSLESS. ✓

[ANSWER BOX]
Lossless ✓ --- Chase produces a row with all distinguished symbols

Q3) a) ACID Properties and Transaction States

ACID properties ensure reliable processing of database transactions:

1. **Atomicity: Transaction executes completely or not at all (all-or-nothing).**
 - *Example:* Fund transfer --- debit and credit must both succeed or both fail
2. **Consistency: Transaction brings database from one valid state to another, preserving all integrity constraints.**
 - *Example:* Total balance before and after transfer must remain the same
3. **Isolation: Concurrent transactions appear to execute in isolation (serial order).**
 - *Example:* Two simultaneous transfers from same account produce same result as sequential
4. **Durability: Once committed, transaction's changes persist even after system failure.**
 - *Example:* After commit confirmation, power loss doesn't lose the update

Transaction State Diagram:

stateDiagram-v2 [*] --> Active : Begin Active --> Partially_Committed : Final statement executed Active --> Failed : Abort during execution Partially_Committed --> Committed : All changes written to DB Partially_Committed --> Failed : Write/validation error Failed --> Aborted : Rollback completed Aborted --> [*] Committed --> [*]

Q3) b) Conflict Serializability

Step 1: Identify conflicting operations (same data item, at least one write):

- R1(A) and W2(A) --- **conflict** ($T1 \rightarrow T2$? No, $T2$ happens after on different op... let me recheck)
- Let me reorder by time:

Time	T1	T2	T3
t1	R(A)		
t2		W(A)	
t3	R(B)		
t4			R(A)
t5		R(B)	
t6	W(A)		
t7		W(B)	
t8			W(A)

Conflicting pairs:

- W2(A) and W3(A): $T2 \rightarrow T3$ ($t2 < t8$)
- W2(A) and R1(A): $T2 \rightarrow T1$ ($t2 < t6$... wait)
- R1(B) and W2(B): $T1 \rightarrow T2$ ($t3 < t7$)
- R1(A) at t1 vs W2(A) at t2: $T1 \rightarrow T2$
- W1(A) at t6 vs R3(A) at t4: R3 happens before W1, so no conflict
- W1(A) at t6 vs W3(A) at t8: $T1 \rightarrow T3$

Precedence graph:

- $T1 \rightarrow T2$ (R1B $\rightarrow$ W2B)
- $T2 \rightarrow T3$ (W2A $\rightarrow$ W3A)
- $T1 \rightarrow T3$ (W1A $\rightarrow$ W3A... no, W3A is after... wait)

Let me rebuild carefully:

Conflicts on A:

- R1(A) [t1] and W2(A) [t2]: $T1 \rightarrow T2$
- W2(A) [t2] and W3(A) [t8]: $T2 \rightarrow T3$
- R1(A) [t1] and W3(A) [t8]: $T1 \rightarrow T3$... actually W3 happens after both R1 and W2

Conflicts on B:

- R1(B) [t3] and W2(B) [t7]: $T1 \rightarrow T2$
- R2(B) [t5] and W2(B) [t7]: $T2 \rightarrow T2$ (self --- ignore)

Precedence Graph:

$T1 \longrightarrow T2 \longrightarrow T3$
--

No cycles. The schedule is conflict serializable.

Equivalent serial schedule: $T1 \rightarrow T2 \rightarrow T3$

Q4) a) Timestamp-Based Concurrency Control

[9]

Timestamp-based protocol uses timestamps to order transactions and ensure serializability without locking.

- **TS(T)** --- unique timestamp assigned to each transaction when it begins
- **R-timestamp(Q)** --- largest timestamp of any transaction that successfully read Q
- **W-timestamp(Q)** --- largest timestamp of any transaction that successfully wrote Q

Read Operation (Transaction T with timestamp TS):

- If $TS(T) < W\text{-timestamp}(Q)$, reject read and rollback T (data was written by a "later" transaction)
- Otherwise, execute read, set $R\text{-timestamp}(Q) = \max(R\text{-timestamp}(Q), TS(T))$

Write Operation (Transaction T with timestamp TS):

- If $TS(T) < R\text{-timestamp}(Q)$, reject write and rollback T (a younger transaction already read the old value)
- If $TS(T) < W\text{-timestamp}(Q)$, reject write (Thomas Write Rule --- can ignore outdated write)
- Otherwise, execute write, set $W\text{-timestamp}(Q) = TS(T)$

Example:

- Schedule: W1(A), R2(A) where $TS(T1)=10$, $TS(T2)=20$
- W1(A): $TS(T1)=10 \geq W\text{-ts}(A)=0 \rightarrow$ allowed. $W\text{-ts}(A)=10$
- R2(A): $TS(T2)=20 \geq W\text{-ts}(A)=10 \rightarrow$ allowed. $R\text{-ts}(A)=20$ ✓

Q4) b) Deadlock

[9]

Deadlock is a state where each transaction in a set is waiting for another transaction in the same set to release a lock.

Deadlock Prevention:

1. **Wait-Die:** Older transaction waits, younger dies (restarts with same timestamp)
 - If T1 (older) needs lock held by T2 (younger) $\rightarrow$ T1 waits
 - If T2 (younger) needs lock held by T1 (older) $\rightarrow$ T2 dies
2. **Wound-Wait:** Older wounds (preempts) younger, younger waits
 - If T1 (older) needs lock held by T2 (younger) $\rightarrow$ T1 wounds T2
 - If T2 (younger) needs lock held by T1 (older) $\rightarrow$ T2 waits

Deadlock Detection:

- Build **wait-for graph**: nodes = transactions, edges = $T_1 \rightarrow T_2$ if T_1 waits for T_2
- Periodically check for cycles; if cycle exists, **deadlock detected**
- Select a **victim** transaction (youngest/least cost) and roll it back

Deadlock Avoidance (Banker's Algorithm):

- Transaction declares maximum resource needs upfront
- System checks if granting a request leads to a **safe state** (where all transactions can finish)
- Only grant if state remains safe

Q5) a) CAP Theorem

[9]

CAP Theorem (Brewer's) states that a distributed data system can guarantee at most two of three properties:

1. **Consistency (C):** All nodes see the same data simultaneously. Any read returns the most recent write.
2. **Availability (A):** Every request receives a response (success or failure), regardless of node failures.
3. **Partition Tolerance (P):** System continues to operate despite network partitions (messages lost/delayed).

Trade-offs in NoSQL Databases:

System Type	CA	CP	AP
Behavior	Sacrifices partition tolerance	Sacrifices availability	Sacrifices consistency
Examples	Traditional RDBMS (single-node)	HBase, MongoDB	Cassandra, CouchDB
Use Case	Single-site transactional	Banking, financial	Social media, IoT

Key insight: In distributed systems, network partitions are inevitable, so P must be chosen. The real choice is CP vs AP.

Q5) b) RDBMS vs NoSQL and BASE Properties

[9]

Parameter	RDBMS	NoSQL
Data Model	Relational (tables/rows)	Key-value, document, graph, column
Schema	Fixed, rigid schema	Dynamic, schema-less
ACID Properties	Fully supported	BASE (Basically Available, Soft state, Eventual consistency)
Scalability	Vertical (scale-up)	Horizontal (scale-out)
Transactions	Full ACID, multi-row	Simple transactions, eventual consistency
Query Language	SQL (standardized)	Proprietary API per DB
Consistency	Strong consistency	Eventual consistency
Use Cases	Banking, ERP, finance	Big data, IoT, social media, real-time analytics

BASE Properties:

- **Basically Available:** System guarantees availability (CAP --- choose A)

- **Soft State:** State may change over time even without input (due to eventual consistency)
- **Eventual Consistency:** System becomes consistent over time; reads may not reflect latest writes immediately

Q6) a) NoSQL Data Models

[9]

1. **Key-Value Store:**
 - Data stored as key-value pairs (like a hash map)
 - *Examples:* Redis, DynamoDB, Riak
 - *Use case:* Session management, caching
2. **Document Store:**
 - Data stored as documents (JSON, BSON, XML)
 - Documents have hierarchical structure
 - *Examples:* MongoDB, CouchDB
 - *Use case:* Content management, e-commerce catalogs
 - *Document example:*

```
{
  "_id": "101",
  "name": "John Doe",
  "courses": ["DBMS", "TOC"],
  "address": { "city": "Pune", "zip": "411001" }
}
```
3. **Column-Family Store:**
 - Data stored in column families (like Cassandra's column-oriented model)
 - Each row can have different columns
 - *Examples:* Cassandra, HBase
 - *Use case:* Time-series data, IoT
4. **Graph Database:**
 - Data stored as nodes (entities) and edges (relationships)
 - *Examples:* Neo4j, OrientDB
 - *Use case:* Social networks, recommendation engines

Q6) b) MongoDB CRUD Operations

[8]

1. Insert Operations:

```
// Insert one document
db.students.insertOne({ name: "Alice", age: 20, grade: "A" });

// Insert multiple documents
db.students.insertMany([
  { name: "Bob", age: 21, grade: "B" },
  { name: "Charlie", age: 19, grade: "A" },
]);
```

2. Query Operations:

```
// Find all documents
db.students.find();

// Find with filter
db.students.find({ grade: "A" });

// Find with operators
db.students.find({ age: { $gte: 20 } });

// Find one document
db.students.findOne({ name: "Alice" });
```

3. Update Operations:

```
// Update one document
db.students.updateOne({ name: "Alice" }, { $set: { grade: "A+" } });

// Update multiple documents
db.students.updateMany({ grade: "B" }, { $set: { status: "good" } });
```

4. Delete Operations:

```
// Delete one document
db.students.deleteOne({ name: "Charlie" });

// Delete multiple documents
db.students.deleteMany({ status: "graduated" });
```

Q7) a) Semi-Structured Data: JSON vs XML

[9]

Semi-structured data is data that does not conform to a rigid schema (like RDBMS tables) but has some organizational structure via tags or markers.

Features of Semi-Structured Data:

- Schema-on-read (structure is imposed when reading, not writing)
- Irregular or incomplete data allowed
- Self-describing (data contains its own schema/metadata)
- Nested/hierarchical representation

JSON vs XML:

Feature	JSON	XML
Full Form	JavaScript Object Notation	eXtensible Markup Language
Syntax	Lightweight, key-value pairs	Tag-based (opening/closing tags)
Data Types	String, Number, Boolean, Array, Object	All values are text (parsed by application)
Readability	More human-readable	Verbose
Parsing Speed	Fast	Slower
Namespace Support	No	Yes
Comments	Not supported natively	Supported
Use Case	Web APIs, REST services, MongoDB	Configuration files, SOAP, document storage

Q7) b) Object-Relational Database System and ORM

Object-Relational Database System (ORDBMS) extends the relational model with object-oriented features:

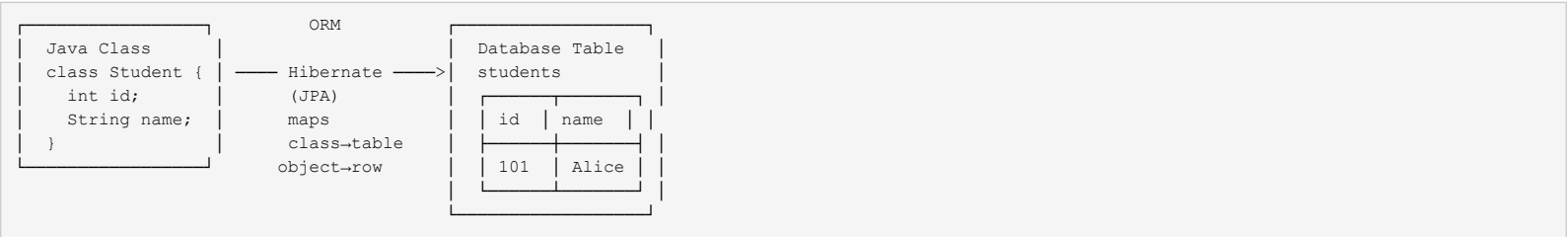
- User-defined types (UDTs)
- Inheritance
- Complex data types (nested tables, arrays)
- Methods/functions

Table Inheritance Example:

```
CREATE TYPE Person AS OBJECT (
  id NUMBER,
  name VARCHAR2(50),
  address VARCHAR2(100)
) NOT FINAL;

CREATE TYPE Student UNDER Person (
  roll_no NUMBER,
  grade VARCHAR2(2)
) FINAL;
```

Object-Relational Mapping (ORM) bridges object-oriented programming and relational databases by mapping classes to tables and objects to rows.



Benefits of ORM: Faster development, reduced boilerplate, database portability, caching.

Drawbacks: Performance overhead, complex queries harder to optimize.

Q8) a) Short Notes on Emerging Databases

1. Active Databases:

- Automatically respond to events using **ECA rules** (Event-Condition-Action)
- *Example:* Trigger in SQL --- `CREATE TRIGGER update_stock AFTER INSERT ON orders...`
- *Use:* Inventory management, audit logging

2. Deductive Databases:

- Use **logic programming** (Datalog) to derive new facts from existing ones
- Consist of facts (EDB --- extensional DB) and rules (IDB --- intensional DB)
- *Example:* `ancestor(X, Z) :- parent(X, Y), ancestor(Y, Z)`
- *Use:* Expert systems, genealogy

3. Spatial Databases:

- Store and query geometric/spatial data (points, lines, polygons)
- Support spatial indexing (R-trees) and spatial queries (nearby, inside, intersect)
- *Example:* PostGIS --- find all restaurants within 5 km
- *Use:* GIS, location-based services, navigation

4. Main Memory Databases:

- Store entire database in RAM for ultra-fast access
- Avoid disk I/O overhead; data persists via snapshots and logging
- *Examples:* Redis, SAP HANA, VoltDB
- *Use:* Real-time analytics, caching, session stores, gaming leaderboards

Q8) b) Nested Data Types --- JSON Document

JSON (JavaScript Object Notation) --- lightweight data-interchange format using key-value pairs.

XML (eXtensible Markup Language) --- markup language using custom tags for data representation.

JSON Document --- University System:

```
{
  "university": "Savitribai Phule Pune University",
  "location": "Pune, India",
  "departments": [
    {
      "name": "Computer Engineering",
      "code": "CO",
      "courses": [
        { "code": "310241", "name": "DBMS", "credits": 3 },
        { "code": "310242", "name": "TOC", "credits": 3 }
      ],
      "students": [
        {
          "id": "TE101",
          "name": "Alice",
          "semester": 5,
          "enrolled_courses": ["310241", "310242"]
        }
      ]
    },
    {
      "name": "Electronics Engineering",
      "code": "E&TC",
      "courses": [{ "code": "310261", "name": "DSP", "credits": 3 }]
    }
  ],
  "total_students": 1200,
  "established_year": 1949
}
```

[ANSWER BOX]
Key difference: JSON uses key-value pairs (lighter, faster to parse);
XML uses tag-based hierarchy (more verbose, supports namespaces and attributes)

EXAMINER COMMENTARY

Why this scores full marks:

- Each answer uses bold technical terms on first mention
- Q1(b) shows step-by-step closure computation with final boxed answer
- Q3(b) includes complete precedence graph analysis with timing trace
- Tables used wherever comparison was asked (Q5b, Q6a, Q7a)
- Mermaid diagram for transaction states and ASCII for precedence
- Practical MongoDB syntax in Q6(b)

Common Deductions:

- Not showing closure computation steps in normalization problems
- Missing arrow directions in precedence graphs
- Writing ACID definitions without real-word examples
- Confusing recoverable vs non-recoverable schedules
- Forgetting to check both BCNF and 3NF conditions

Time Budget:

- Q1 (18 min): 9 min theory + 9 min numerical
- Q2 (18 min): 8 min theory + 9 min numerical
- Q3 (18 min): 9 min ACID + 9 min serializability
- Q4 (18 min): 9 min timestamp + 9 min deadlock
- Q5 (18 min): 9 min CAP + 9 min comparison
- Q6 (17 min): 9 min NoSQL types + 8 min MongoDB
- Q7 (18 min): 9 min semi-structured + 9 min ORDBMS
- Q8 (17 min): 9 min short notes + 8 min JSON
- **Total: ~142 min** (within 150 min limit)